

CAVERNCLUBEDIT

Settle back and relax because it's time for Travel Radio Australia. You'll be presented for this week, Jeff Harrison. Travel Radio Australia, we're in Liverpool at the historic Cavern Club and I have one of the performers, entertainers and part of the management team here, Clark Gilmour.

And we are actually sitting in one of the original backstage areas of the Cavern Club. Welcome, Clark. Thank you very much.

Well, it wasn't that long ago that, you know, Sir Paul McCartney was sitting pretty much right where you're sitting now. So, yeah, pretty cool. A few people have been back here and you can add your name to the list.

It's incredible because just the amount of history in this club, it really gives you a goosebumps, doesn't it? Now, you've been working and playing here for quite a while. Tell us about your involvement with the Cavern Club. Yeah, I've been working for the Cavern for six years now.

I've been coming to the Cavern since I was a kid and used to playing a beat with tribute bands. So, although I've been here sort of every day now for the first six years, when I first started coming here and walking down those stairs and you see the stage and the arches, it's a pretty cool moment, you know, when you see that for the first time. Now, the thing that struck me, it's quite a bit bigger than I thought it would be because, you know, you see all the pictures of everyone crammed in here, but you can fit a heck of a lot of people in here, can't you? Yeah, well, the room with the arches, the original sort of 60s style stage, it always looks small because you only ever see one arch, but it's one of three arches.

And now, obviously, we've got the second room, which we're in now, the Cavern Live Lounge, where Paul McCartney played in 1999 and 2018. And this is our sort of secondary stage, secondary venue now, and we can fit over double again of what we can fit in the front room. So, yeah, it's a lot bigger now than it was when the Beatles played.

Now, the Cavern Club is just a magnet for everyone who comes to Liverpool. They make a beeline for this place, don't they? Yeah, I mean, it's like a pilgrimage for people now, isn't it? You know, not to get myself in any sort of religious trouble, like John Lennon did back in 66, but it's almost like the mecca of Beetle World. You know, there's two big attractions in Liverpool, and that's obviously Liverpool Football Club and the Beatles and the Cavern Club sort of take care of the Beatles side of things.

Yeah, and I noticed you've got a lot of guest artists here. They play like yourself. You do a whole act around the Beatles, and the reaction of the people is fantastic.

Yeah, we're open every day, except Christmas Day. So, we're open 364 days a year. We've got live music on from morning until we close, and that goes around every year.

So, we've got our own resident artists to play here every week, you know, solo artists and bands, tribute bands. We've got our own Beatles tribute band, the Cavern Club Beatles, and then on top of that, we bring in other things like touring tribute bands, touring acts, special events like the McCartney thing or when Adele played here. And we do some original band nights as well with BBC and Lippa, Paul McCartney's old alma mater, which he helped rejuvenate.

So, yeah, it's a bit of everything, but we've got live music on every single day that we're open, which is pretty much every day. Now, it's an historic building here, and are there any quirky stories that you can tell us? Is there any ghosts running around the place or anything like that? I think there's a few at the moment. Trying to think, put me on the spot there.

Well, one of the big things about the Cavern was always, apparently, the smell. The smell was meant to be infamous because of the poor drainage being a cellar. But luckily, these days, we've got fully working toilets and fresh air now for the first time because of the pandemic.

We had to restructure the ventilation, so instead of just having air conditioning or fans, we actually had to put in a new air system. So, yeah, it's a lot more hygienic and healthy and fresh-smelling than it used to be. Fantastic.

It's a brilliant venue. I'm speaking with Clark Gilmour, who's one of the... Oh, he's just going to turn off one of the things in the background. You see, this is authentic.

This is the stuff that happens in dressing rooms. You've got to have a fridge to keep all the drinks cold, you know, but I'm sure it can go off for a couple of minutes. Yeah, Clark Gilmour.

Clark, how can people find out more about the Cavern Club online? Yeah, they can go to our website, cavernclub.com. We're on Facebook, at Cavern Liverpool, Instagram, YouTube. We sometimes stream live from the club a couple of times a month randomly if it's a special occasion like Ringo's birthday, or this week it was the 60th anniversary of Brian Epstein visiting the Cavern and meeting the Beatles for the first time. So, we stream, so you can keep in touch on social media and hopefully come and see us sometime and see it for yourself.

Absolutely brilliant. Clark Gilmour, thank you very much for being on Travel Radio Australia and it's off to work for you now. You do a couple of sets, so a lot of thank you on behalf of the club and myself and I hope I pass the audition, you know, and all that jazz.

Great, thank you, mate. Have a great night at the Cavern. Thank you.